governance than as an aid in more limited and practical goals: providing a bit of leverage vis-à-vis China or increasing foreign sources for African infrastructure investment. The assessment in South Africa's *Mail and Guardian* was typical: "Membership of the BRICS can help Africa with most if not all of the initiatives [of the World Economic Forum on Africa and the African Union Summit]… . [D]eveloping countries [have] to double spending on infrastructure to $2-trillion a year by 2020, with the bulk of this money to be directed to sub-Saharan Africa, . . . Brics [sic], through the New Development Bank . . . can help drive financing of that infrastructure… . [The NDB] would need to be a lead funder and attract the World Bank, Sovereign Wealth Funds, and global pension funds to help close the funding gap."[288] The South African government also hopes that the NDB can help with financing the region's New Partnership for African Development (NEPAD), a project of the African Union.

Overall, South Africa's choices about participating in BRICS collective financial statecraft suggest that its leaders are pragmatic. They accept their nation's position as essentially a regional rather than an actual or potential global power, and have behaved accordingly: uniting behind international political positions that have neither strong benefits nor profound costs for themselves while focusing on what does matter, which is attracting new investment to sub-Saharan Africa, particularly in physical infrastructure, which arguably is a crucial prerequisite for future economic growth.

CONCLUSION: EXPLAINING BRICS COLLABORATION

The analyses of these five countries reveal a mix of different motivations among BRICS countries for pursuing collective financial statecraft. Returning to the six propositions about possible reasons for BRICS collective financial statecraft, this conclusion identifies possible patterns from the analysis of the countries' motivations.

Proposition 1. Collective financial statecraft among the BRICS countries is more likely when collaboration magnifies the signal to the incumbent powers that they are dissatisfied with current global financial governance.

The signaling of common dissatisfaction with current global financial governance has proved an important joint motivation, especially among the original four BRICs: China, Russia, Brazil, and India. Collaboration enabled each of them to amplify its criticisms of the shortcomings, double